

1Q25 Result: Guidance Dropped, Capital Return Reaffirmed

UOB reported 1Q25 net profit of S\$1.5bn, flat yoy/-3% qoq, inline with cons and 3% below JEF. Revenue +4% yoy/+6% qoq, 3% ahead of cons but 3% below JEF against higher expectation on trading & other income and AIEA growth. Cost was flat yoy/-1% qoq, largely inline with JEF/cons. CoR rose 12bps yoy/10bps qoq to 35bps, due mainly to GP. CET1 is flat qoq at 15.4%. UOB dropped 2025 guidance and remains committed to the S\$3bn capital distribution plan.

Key positives - 1) Strong non-II. Fee income +20% yoy/+22% qoq to new quarterly high, 4%/7% ahead of JEF/cons, driven by strong momentum across loan/trade related fees (+28% yoy), wealth (+30% yoy) and card (+11% yoy), positive readacross for other SG banks. Trading and other income however -5% yoy from a high base although still +25% qoq, 1%/8% below JEF/cons, with customer related income grew steadily +11% yoy/+13% qoq offset by lower episodic income yoy. **2) NIM stable** qoq at 2.00%, with lower loan margin -8bps qoq offset by higher interbank & securities margin (+15bps qoq). Loan growth was +1% qoq/+6% yoy; total funding was flat qoq/+4% yoy, of which CASA ratio improved +0.5ppt qoq/+4.5ppt yoy to 55.1%. NII was 2% lower qoq, mainly on shorter quarter and a lack of qoq growth in AIEA. **3) Cost control.** Opex was flat yoy/-1% qoq. CIR improved 2.0ppt yoy to 42.6%.

Key negatives - 1) Provision higher. CoR rose +12bps yoy/+10bps qoq to 35bps, of which SP improved 1bps yoy/33bps qoq to 19bps offset by higher GP. NPL ratio edged higher by 0.1ppt qoq to 1.6%, with S\$400mn new NPAs (+60% yoy/-22% qoq) offset by somewhat lower recoveries. NPA coverage fell 1ppt qoq/9ppt yoy to 90%.

Outlook - 1) UOB dropped 2025 guidance and will resume when situation stabilises, **2)** remain committed to S\$3bn capital distribution plan, **3)** expect China-ASEAN and intra-ASEAN trade flows to continue with growing hedging demand, also see healthy pipeline of infrastructure financing.

Implications - Results were broadly inline with cons, although marginally below JEF's above-street forecasts. We expect more detailed assessment on the uncertain macro environment from the call (media briefing 9am, analysts 10:30am). Market could react negatively to the lack of guidance for 2025. Reiterate our preference for DBS within SG banks.

FLASH NOTE

RATING BUY

PRICE SGD34.98*

PRICE TARGET | % TO PT SGD43.00 | +23%

52W HIGH-LOW SGD39.20 - SGD29.00

FLOAT (%) | ADV MM (USD) 75.0% | 120.61

MARKET CAP SGD58.5B | \$45.4B

TICKER UOB SP

*Prior trading day's closing price unless otherwise noted.

Figure 1 - UOB 1Q25 Result Snapshot

	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YTD %	QoQ %	2024	2025	2026	2027
Key Financial Metrics (\$Bn)											
Net interest income	2,362	2,451	2,485	2,451	2,459	-2%	-7%	2,355	-4%	2,365	2%
Net fee income	550	618	620	627	624	20%	23%	617	4%	646	7%
Other income	561	617	714	657	554	-5%	-25%	622	-4%	522	-14%
Total income	3,473	3,685	3,819	3,735	3,637	4%	-4%	3,594	-2%	3,533	-2%
Costs	(1,544)	(1,513)	(1,438)	(1,375)	(1,339)	-1%	-2%	(1,342)	-1%	(1,327)	1%
Pre-provision profit	1,929	2,172	2,381	2,360	2,298	7%	3%	2,252	-4%	2,206	-2%
Asset loss provisions	(1,171)	(1,298)	(1,311)	(1,235)	(1,217)	7%	28%	(1,251)	-7%	(1,252)	2%
Operating profit	758	874	1,070	1,125	1,081	4%	4%	1,001	-2%	954	-5%
Net profit (including one-off)	1,486	1,456	1,618	1,537	1,491	4%	-2%	1,541	-2%	1,462	-2%
Key Balance Sheet Items (\$Bn)											
Loan	322.6	335.5	334.0	337.8	341.2	4%	1%				
Key Financial Ratios (%)											
Pre-tax NII	54.5%	57.4%	54.4%	54.4%	54.4%	10.0%	2.5ppt	54.5%			
Cost to income	44.1%	43.8%	42.2%	45.2%	42.6%	(2.5ppt)	(2.5ppt)	42.6%			
NII	2.02%	2.02%	2.02%	2.02%	2.02%	(2ppt)	(2ppt)	2.02%			
Cost to loan	23	24	24	25	25	(10ppt)	(20ppt)	25			

Source: Jefferies, Company

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Figure 2 - UOB 1Q25 Result Snapshot

	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	JEF 1Q25E	Diff	Cons 1Q25E	diff
P&L (\$\$ MM)											
Net interest income	2,362	2,401	2,460	2,451	2,409	2%	-2%	2,500	-4%	2,360	2%
Net fee income	580	618	630	567	694	20%	22%	667	4%	646	7%
Other income	581	457	744	443	554	-5%	25%	600	-8%	559	-1%
Total income	3,523	3,475	3,834	3,461	3,657	4%	6%	3,767	-3%	3,566	3%
Opex	(1,554)	(1,515)	(1,618)	(1,575)	(1,559)	0%	-1%	(1,582)	-1%	(1,537)	1%
Pre-provision profit	1,969	1,960	2,216	1,886	2,098	7%	11%	2,185	-4%	2,028	3%
Asset loss provisions	(170)	(238)	(311)	(235)	(297)	75%	26%	(320)	-7%	(251)	18%
Operating profit	1,799	1,722	1,905	1,651	1,801	0%	9%	1,865	-3%	1,778	1%
Net profit (including one off)	1,486	1,426	1,610	1,537	1,491	0%	-3%	1,541	-3%	1,483	1%
Key balance sheet items (\$\$bn)											
Loan	322.6	328.5	334.0	337.8	341.2	6%	1%				
Key financial ratios (%)											
Fee as % of income	16.5%	17.8%	16.4%	16.4%	19.0%	2.5pp	2.6pp				
Cost to income	44.1%	43.6%	42.2%	45.5%	42.6%	(1.5pp)	(2.9pp)				
NIM	2.02%	2.05%	2.05%	2.00%	2.00%	(2bp)	0bp	2.00%	0bp		
Credit cost (bps)	23	24	34	25	35	12bp	10bp				

Source: Jefferies, Company

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We would like to thank Iris Tian, employee of Evalueserve Inc., for providing research support services to our preparation of this report.

Company Description

United Overseas Bank Ltd.

United Overseas Bank Ltd. provides a wide range of financial services. The company operates a global network of branches, offices, subsidiaries and associates. It is engaged in the business of providing personal financial services, private banking, commercial and corporate banking, investment banking, corporate finance, capital market activities, treasury services, futures broking, asset management, venture capital management, insurance and stock broking services. UOB also has diversified interests in travel and property management. It also offers loans to small and medium enterprises. The company operates through the following major banking subsidiaries: Far Eastern Bank, United Overseas Bank (Malaysia), United Overseas Bank (Thai), PT Bank UOB Buana and United Overseas Bank (China). It has operations in Asia Pacific, Western Europe and North America. The company was founded by Wee Kheng Chiang on August 6, 1935, and is headquartered in Singapore.

Company Valuation/Risks

United Overseas Bank Ltd.

Our PT of S\$43 is based on a 11.5x multiple applied to 12m fwd EPS. Key upside risks include better-than-expected loan growth, margins and asset quality. Key downside risks include sudden reversal of liquidity, wider credit spreads, risk premium, and trade frictions.

DBS Group Holdings Ltd.

Our PT of S\$52 is based on an 13x multiple to 12m forward EPS. Key upside risks include better-than-expected loan growth, margins and asset quality. Key downside risks include worse-than-expected asset quality/any large NPA formation, dialling down of rate hike/steeper yield curve expectations

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(Article 3(1)e and Article 7 of MAR)

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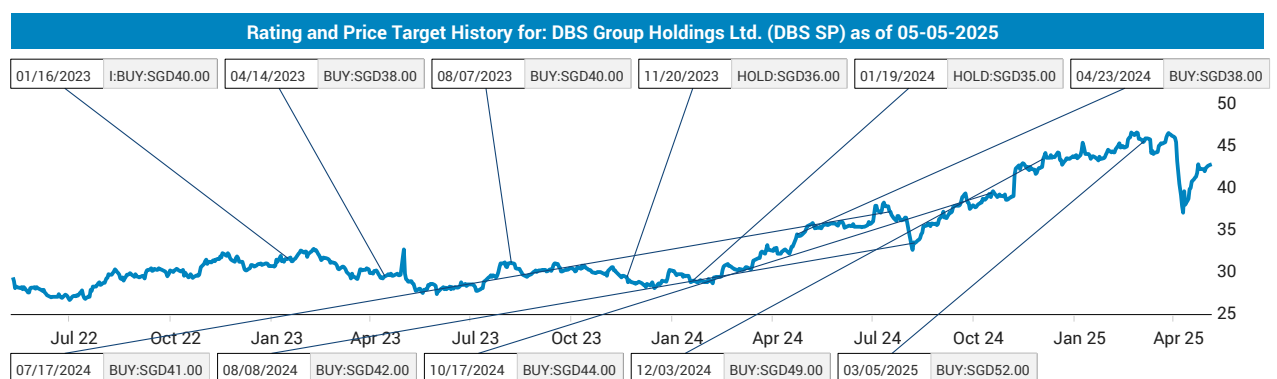
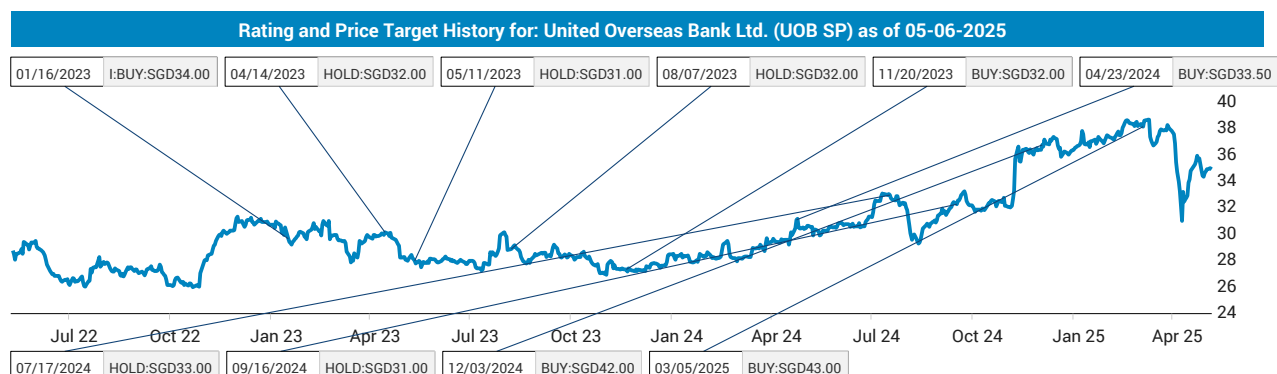
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- DBS Group Holdings Ltd. (DBS SP: SGD42.99, BUY)
- United Overseas Bank Ltd. (UOB SP: SGD34.98, BUY)



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I: Initiating Coverage

D: Dropped Coverage

B: Buy

H: Hold

UP: Underperform

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	Count	Percent	Count	Percent
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